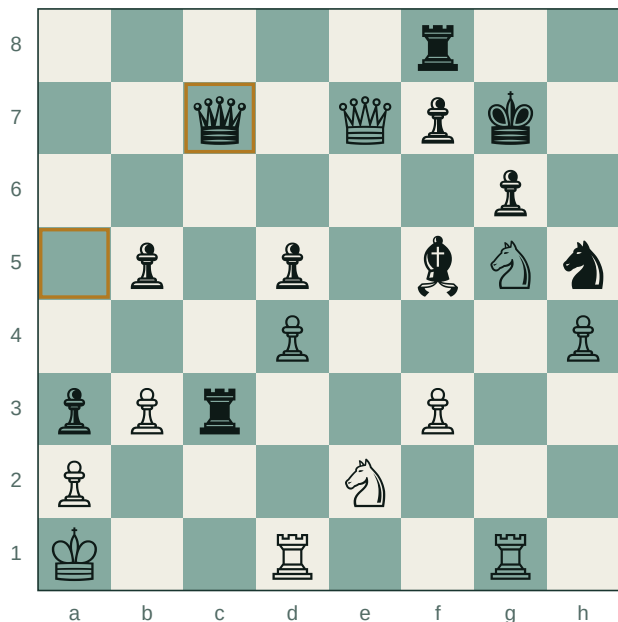


Attraction tactics: White, move 28

Attraction tactics

White to move



Previous move: 27...Qc7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

28. Ne6+ Bxe6 29. Rxg6+ Kh7 30. Rh6+ Kxh6 31. Qg5+ Kh7 32. Qxh5+

28.Ne6+ Check restricts Black to 5 legal replies here. From e6 it attacks king on g7, queen on c7 and rook on f8. Recorded reply: **28...Bxe6**.

29.Rxg6+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. From g6 it attacks king on g7 and bishop on e6. Recorded reply: **29...Kh7**.

30.Rh6+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. From h6 it attacks king on h7, knight on h5 and bishop on e6. Recorded reply: **30...Kxh6**.

31.Qg5+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From g5 it attacks king on h6 and knight on h5. Recorded reply: **31...Kh7**.

32.Qxh5+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the knight on h5.

At the end, nominal material is White 22 / Black 26 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by -4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** -4: the balance goes from +0 to -4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on g7. Absolute pin: pawn on f7.